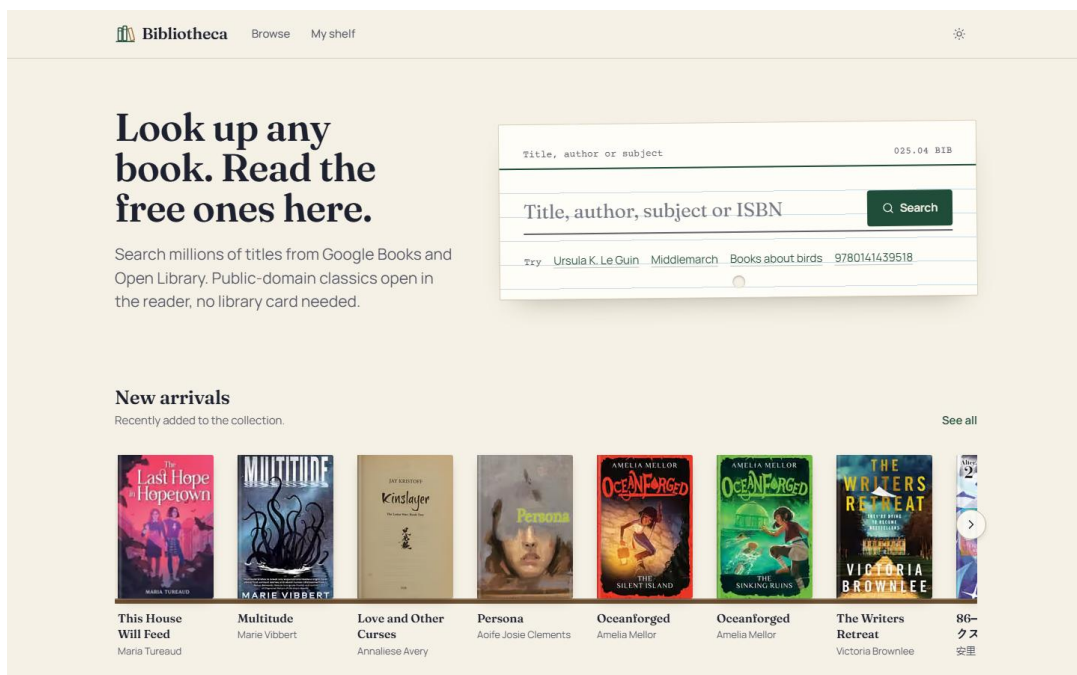


USER MANUAL

Bibliotheca

Your library's digital catalog

Find books. Read free classics. Keep track of what you read.



The Bibliotheca home page

What's inside

- 1** Getting started
- 2** Finding a book
- 3** Looking at a book
- 4** Reading a book
- 5** Your shelf
- 6** Your account (optional)
- 7** Using a phone
- 8** For library staff
- 9** Questions and problems

1 Getting started

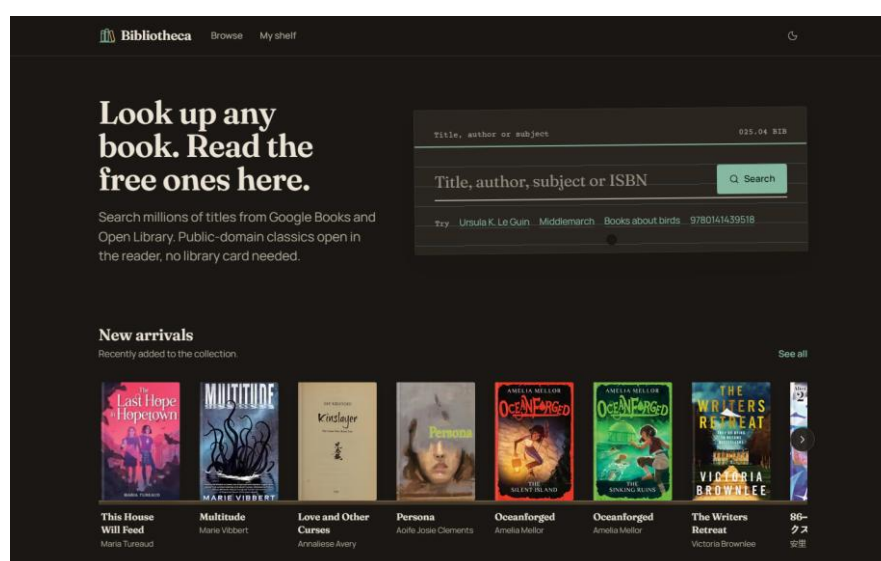
Bibliotheca works in any web browser on a computer, tablet or phone. There is nothing to install.

1. Open your web browser (Chrome, Edge, Safari or Firefox).
2. Go to the Bibliotheca address your library gave you.
3. You are ready. You can search and read straight away, no account needed.

The top bar

The bar at the top of every page is how you move around:

You see	What it means
Bibliotheca	Takes you back to the home page from anywhere.
Browse	Pick a genre, such as Mystery, History or Poetry.
My shelf	The books you have saved.
Search box	Search from any page.
Sun / moon button	Switch between light mode and dark mode . Click again to match your device.
Sign in	Optional. Keeps your shelf on all your devices.



The same page in dark mode, easier on the eyes at night

2 Finding a book

Search

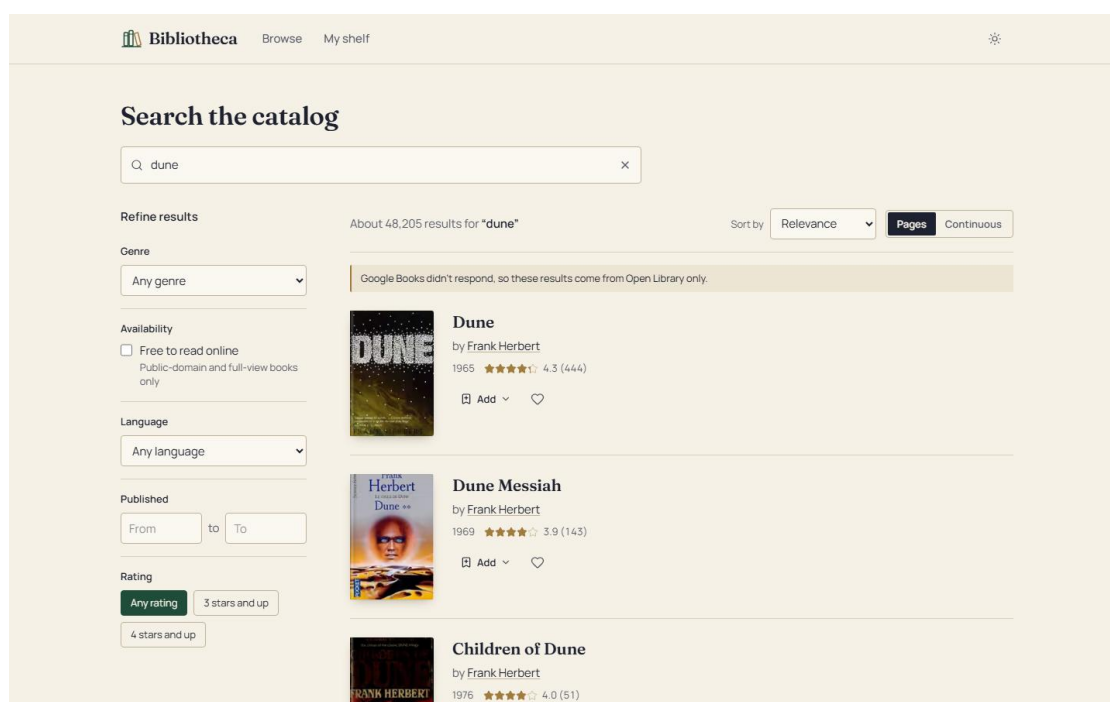
1. Click the big search box on the home page.
2. Type a **title**, an **author**, a **topic** (for example “birds”) or the **ISBN** number from the back of a book.
3. Suggestions appear while you type. Click one to open that book, or press **Enter** to see all results.

Narrow the results

On the left side of the results (on a phone, tap **Filters**) you can choose:

- **Genre**: only mysteries, only poetry, and so on.
- **Free to read online**: only books you can read right now at no cost.
- **Language** and **Published** years.
- **Rating**: only books rated 3 or 4 stars and up.

Use **Sort by** to put the newest, highest rated, or A–Z titles first.

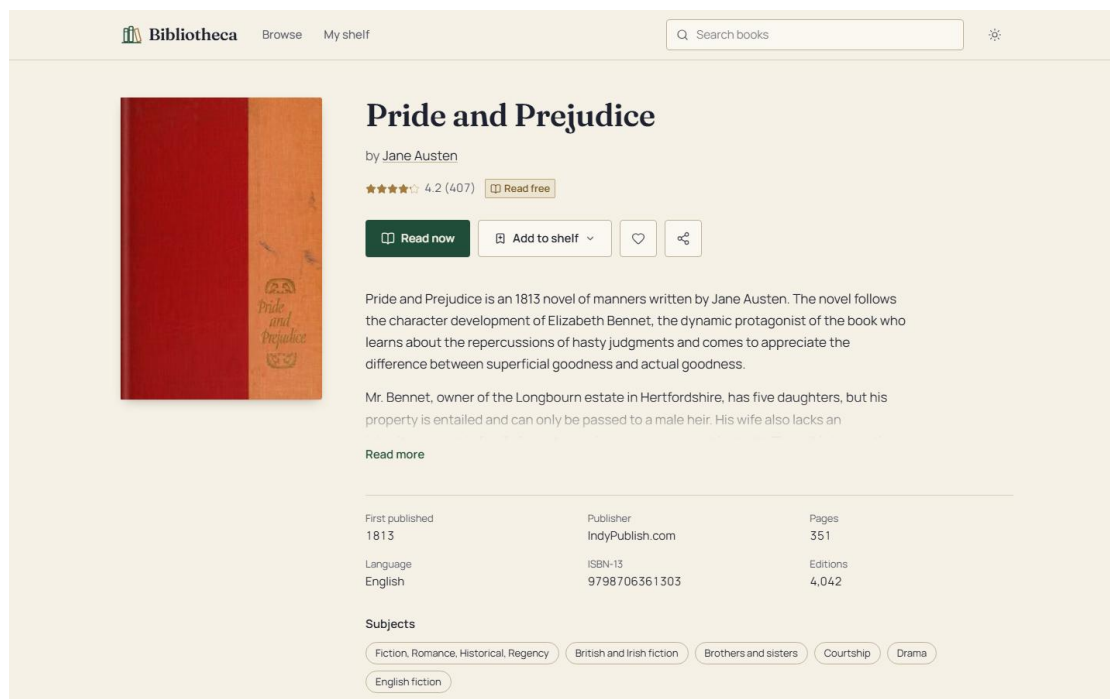


Search results with filters on the left

Tip: No results? Check the spelling, use fewer words, or try just the author's surname.

3 Looking at a book

Click any book to open its page. You will see the cover, the author, a description, the number of pages, and more.



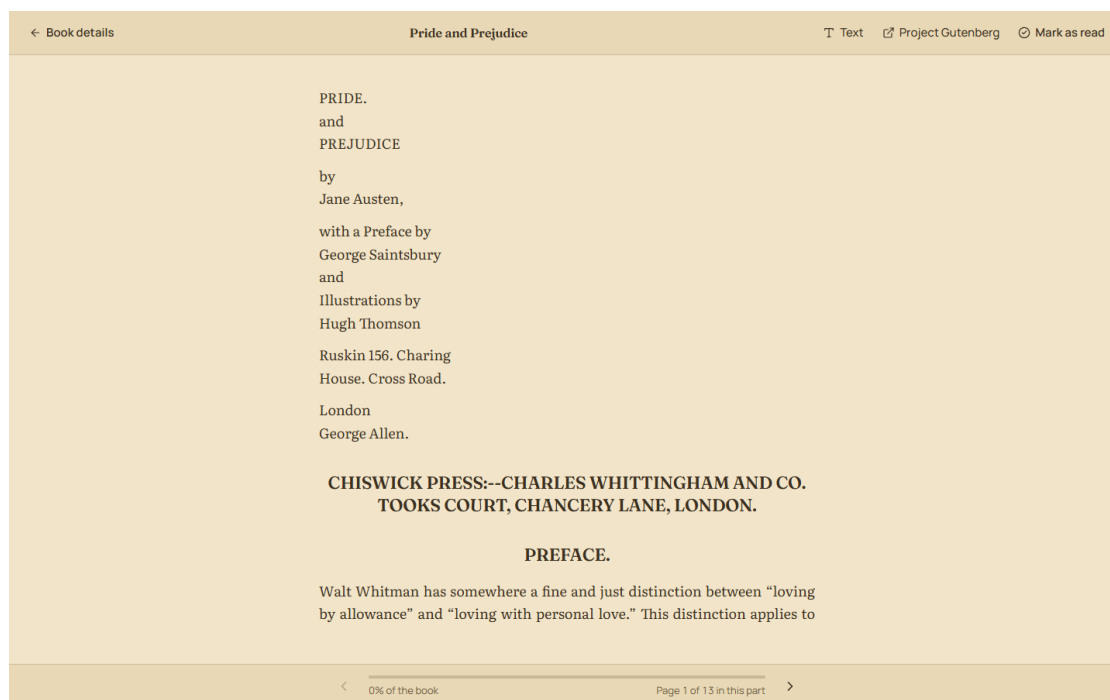
A book page

You see	What it means
Read now	The book is free to read. Click to open it.
Read a preview	The publisher lets you read some pages.
Check availability	Not free online. Shows libraries near you that have it.
Read free badge	A quick sign that the whole book is free.
Add to shelf	Save the book to one of your lists (see section 5).
Heart	Add the book to your Favorites.
Share	Copy a link to send to someone.

Click the **author's name** to see their other books. Scroll down for **More like this** and **Reader reviews**.

4 Reading a book

Click **Read now** on a book page. The book opens full screen.



The reader, here in the Sepia color

Turning pages

- Click the > and < arrows at the bottom of the screen, or
- press the **left and right arrow keys** on your keyboard, or
- **swipe** left and right on a phone or tablet.

Making it comfortable

Tap **Text** at the top to change:

- **Theme:** Light, Sepia (warm paper) or Dark.
- **Typeface:** Serif (like a printed book) or Sans serif.
- **Text size:** tap + or –.
- **Line spacing:** Tight, Normal or Loose.

Stopping and coming back

Just close the page. Bibliotheca **remembers your page** and opens it there next time. The bar at the bottom shows how far through the book you are.

When you finish, tap **Mark as read**. To leave the reader, tap **Book details** in the top-left corner.

5 Your shelf

Your shelf keeps track of the books you care about. There are four lists:

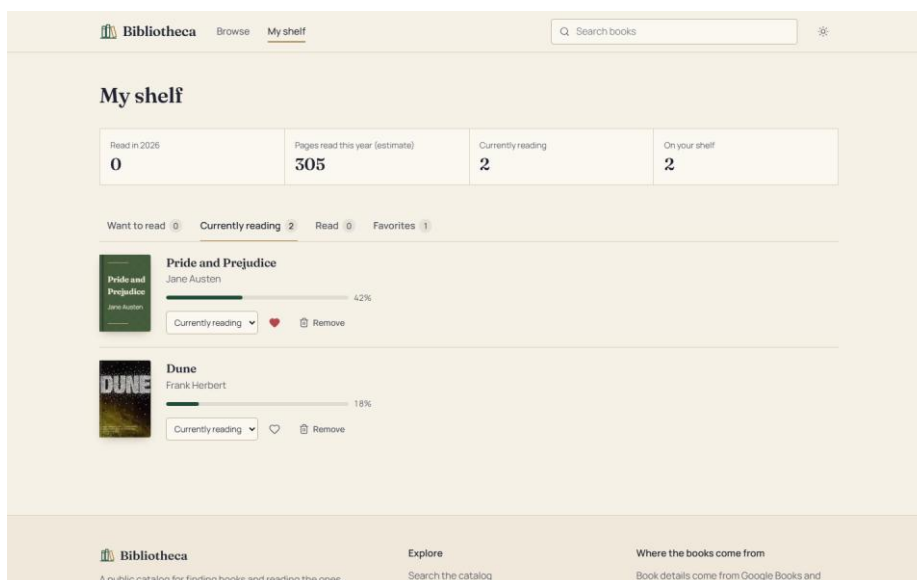
You see	What it means
Want to read	Books for later.
Currently reading	Books you have started. Shows how far you got.
Read	Books you have finished, with the date.
Favorites	Books you marked with the heart.

Add a book

1. On a book page (or in search results), tap **Add to shelf**.
2. Choose **Want to read**, **Currently reading** or **Read**.

See and change your shelf

1. Click **My shelf** in the top bar.
2. Click a tab to see that list.
3. To move a book, use the dropdown under it. To take it off, click **Remove**.



My shelf, with reading progress and yearly numbers

Good to know: Without an account your shelf is saved only in this browser. Sign in to keep it on every device.

6 Your account (optional)

You never need an account to search or read. An account keeps your shelf and reviews safe and lets you use them on any device.

Create an account

1. Click **Sign in** at the top, then **Get a library card**.
2. Type your name, email and a password (at least 8 characters).
3. Open the email we send you and click the link inside.
4. Done. Books you saved before signing up move into your account automatically.

Or click **Continue with Google** to use your Google account, if your library has turned it on.

Things you can do when signed in

- **Write reviews:** on any book page, choose stars and write a few words.
- **Change your name:** top-right menu → **Account settings**.
- **Download your data:** Account settings → **Download my data**.
- **Delete your account:** Account settings → **Delete my account**. This removes everything and cannot be undone.

Forgot your password?

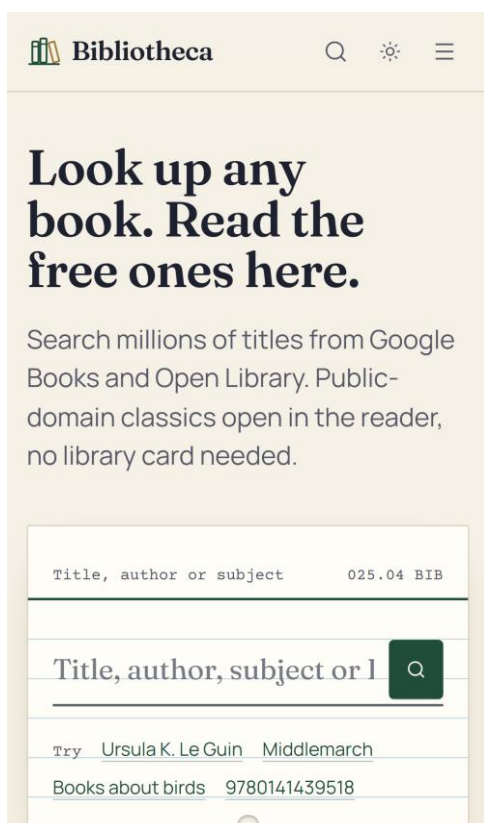
On the sign-in page click **Forgot password?**, type your email, and follow the link we send you.

Important: On a shared library computer, always **Sign out** when you finish (top-right menu). Your shelf is then removed from that computer.

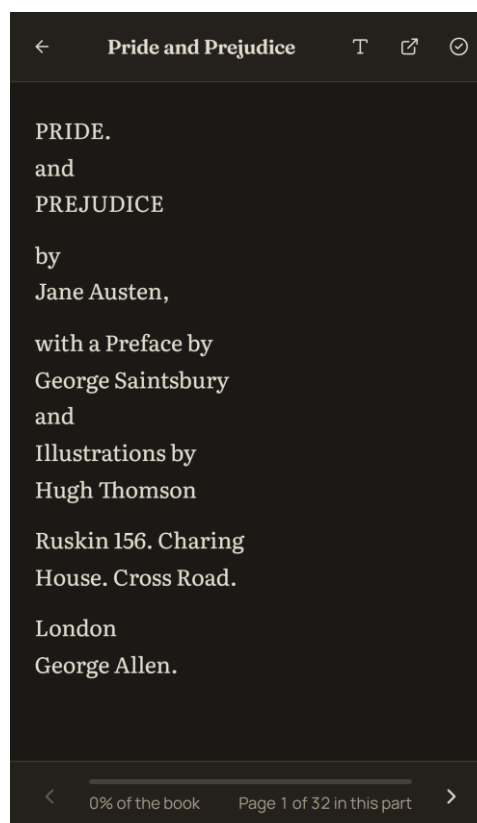
7 Using a phone

Everything works on a phone. A few things move to save space:

- The **≡ menu** in the top-right corner holds Browse, My shelf and your account.
- The **magnifying glass** opens search.
- Search filters open from the **Filters** button as a panel from the bottom. Tap **Show results** when you are done.
- In the reader, **swipe** to turn pages.



Home page on a phone



Reading on a phone, dark theme

8 For library staff

Staff accounts see **Library staff tools** in the top-right menu.

Choose books for the home page

1. Open **Library staff tools**.
2. Under **Staff picks** or **New arrivals**, type a title in **Find a book to add** and click **Search**.
3. Click **Add** next to the right book.
4. Use the **up and down arrows** to change the order, or the **bin** to remove a book.

Tip: A shelf needs at least 4 books to show on the home page. Until then, the home page chooses books automatically.

See what people are looking for

The same page shows the **Top searches** and the **Most shelved** books from the last 30 days. Searches are anonymous.

Making someone staff

An administrator runs this in the Supabase SQL editor, using the person's email address:

```
update public.profiles set role = 'staff' where id = (select id from auth.users where email = 'name@example.com');
```

9 Questions and problems

Why can't I read every book?

Most books are still under copyright. Bibliotheca only opens books that are legally free. For the rest, **Check availability** shows libraries near you that have a copy.

A book page says a book service "didn't respond".

One of the book sources was slow for a moment. Wait a few seconds and click **Try again**.

My shelf is empty on my other device.

Your shelf is saved in one browser until you sign in. Sign in on both devices with the same account.

I didn't get the confirmation email.

Check your spam folder. Still nothing after a few minutes? Sign up again with the same email.

The text is too small to read.

In the reader tap **Text**, then **+**. On other pages, use your browser zoom (Ctrl and + on a computer, pinch on a phone).

Covers look blurred with "Mature content".

Some books are for adult readers. Tap **Show cover** to see it. Signed-in adults can turn blurring off in Account settings.

The screen is too bright at night.

Click the **sun / moon** button for dark mode. In the reader, choose the **Dark** or **Sepia** theme.

Need help: Still stuck? Ask a member of library staff. They will be happy to help.